

together,” said David Auten, half of the LGBTQ finance podcast *Queer Money*, in an interview for this book. Auten and his partner, John Schneider, worked at a top financial firm with more than \$1 billion in advertising budgets, none of which went to marketing to anyone other than straight white cis able-bodied people, he said.

Statistically, the LGBTQ community (except *maybe* cis white gay men) isn’t targeted, Schneider said, because they don’t have as much money. For example, 40 percent of homeless youth identify as LGBTQ, and trans women of color have an average income of just \$10,000 a year. That’s not enough capital to think about putting something away. Some people (like those with disabilities) are even punished for saving. On my podcast, disability activist Carrie Wade told me that if a disabled person has more than \$2,000 in the bank, their SSI benefits can be cut. (This is horrific, outdated, and needs to be changed.) Wade also informed me that people with disabilities could also lose their benefits if they marry someone with a higher salary, one that pushes them over the \$2,000 cap.

The game developer Amy Dentata tweeted in response to the *Today Show*’s financial editor, Jean Chatzky (who has been a guest on my show), alerting her to this disability cap. Chatzky had tweeted, “By the time you’re 30, aim to have 1x your annual income set aside for retirement. At 40, 3x; at 50, 6x; at 60, 8x; and by retirement, 10x.” Dentata took issue with retirement coming at age 70 now, much later than in previous generations, which means people need to work longer to survive due to lower pay and the rising costs of basically everything. My father is 71 years old and does not have retirement savings. (I take issue with the “by *x* age, you should have *y*” format.)

Like Wade, Dentata reminded Chatzky that disabled people have limits, explaining that the cap on the amount of income and assets a disabled person can have before losing benefits was set in the 1980s. It’s never been adjusted for inflation or to reflect the increased cost of living. Basically, people on SSI are not legally allowed to save for retirement.

Meaningful retirement savings also require a level of financial knowledge and access to money that many people do not and cannot have. This all needs to be acknowledged. But for now, let’s answer some basic questions you might have about retirement funds if you’re looking into having one, like what’s a 401(k)